The difference in social origin (Mizrahim versus Ashkenazim) between the two opposing camps saw sad expression in the letter sent today by tens of Air Force mechanics to the defense minister, the chief of staff, and the commander of the Air Force. They declared that the refusal of thirty-seven fighter pilots to answer call-ups made them feel like second-class citizens and demanded that these pilots not be readmitted for service if they do not apologize for their initiative.

Thursday, March 30

It seems that Gallant will stay in office; though he may have to apologize for the public way he announced his concerns regarding the security of the country, while Netanyahu was in London.

On the other hand, a hardline religious-nationalist extremist, Avihai Boaron, will join Likud MKs, replacing Amsalem, who has been appointed to the Justice Department (how his domain will infringe upon Levin's remains to be seen). This new MK is a particularly fanatic representative of the "second-class citizens" and the organizer of the demonstration of supporters of the overhaul that took place in Jerusalem. Today they will march in Tel Aviv, from the Museum Place to the government district. Social resentment turns the political confrontation into a powder keg. It is this powder keg that Netanyahu exploits relentlessly to achieve his political-judicial goal.

If Netanyahu and his acolytes take seriously the counter-protest of the right that they organized, or if they just pretend to, they may parade it as an expression of a popular will to scuttle talks they didn't want in the first place. Only US pressure can stop them, and even this will not do much to ease internal tensions that have reached a boiling point.

A small sign of hope: some 2,000 young people from all social and political backgrounds were brought together in Hayarkon Park in Tel Aviv,